Supplementary Table 1: Search strategy to identify papers indexed in Ovid MEDLINE, EMBASE and CINAHL

Ovid MEDLINE

Search #	Search terms
1	exp Neoplasms/
2	(cancer* or neoplasm*).mp. [mp=title, abstract, original title, name of substance word, subject heading word, keyword heading word, protocol supplementary concept word, rare disease supplementary concept word, unique identifier]
3	1 or 2
4	cancer survival.mp. [mp=title, abstract, original title, name of substance word, subject heading word, keyword heading word, protocol supplementary concept word, rare disease supplementary concept word, unique identifier]
5	(relative survival or excess mortality).mp. [mp=title, abstract, original title, name of substance word, subject heading word, keyword heading word, protocol supplementary concept word, rare disease supplementary concept word, unique identifier]
6	exp survival analysis/
7	3 and 5
8	3 and 6
9	((cancer* or tumor* or tumour*) adj3 (survival or surviving or prognosis)).mp. [mp=title, abstract, original title, name of substance word, subject heading word, keyword heading word, protocol supplementary concept word, rare disease supplementary concept word, unique identifier]
10	4 or 7 or 8 or 9
11	((socioeconomic or socio economic or social or economic or income or education* or occupation) adj5 (inequalit* or inequit* or disparit* or disadvantag* or factor* or class or difference* or status or position* or variation* or depriv* or effect* or determinant* or characteristic* or level*)).mp. [mp=title, abstract, original title, name of substance word, subject heading word, keyword heading word, protocol supplementary concept word, rare disease supplementary concept word, unique identifier]
12	10 and 11
13	Limit 12 to English language

EMBASE

Search #	Search terms
1	exp Neoplasms/
2	(cancer* or neoplasm*).mp. [mp=title, abstract, heading word, drug trade name, original title, device manufacturer, drug manufacturer, device trade name, keyword]
3	1 or 2
4	exp cancer survival/
5	(relative survival or excess mortality).mp. [mp=title, abstract, heading word, drug trade name, original title, device manufacturer, drug manufacturer, device trade name, keyword]
6	3 and 4
7	3 and 5
8	((cancer* or tumor* or tumour*) adj3 (survival or surviving or prognosis)).mp. [mp=title, abstract, heading word, drug trade name, original title, device manufacturer, drug manufacturer, device trade name, keyword]
9	6 or 7 or 8
10	((socioeconomic or socio economic or social or economic or income or education* or occupation) adj5 (inequalit* or inequit* or disparit* or disadvantag* or factor* or class or difference* or status or position* or variation* or depriv* or effect* or determinant* or characteristic* or level*)).mp. [mp=title, abstract, heading word, drug trade name, original title, device manufacturer, drug manufacturer, device trade name, keyword]
11	9 and 10
12	Limit 11 to English language

CINAHL

Search #	Search terms
S1	MH "Neoplasms+"
S2	cancer* or neoplasm*
S3	S1 or S2
S4	cancer survival
S5	relative survival or excess mortality
S6	MH "Survival Analysis+"
S7	S3 and S5
S8	S3 and S6
S9	(cancer* or tutor* or tumour*) N3 (survival or surviving or prognosis)
S10	S4 or S7 or S8 or S9
S11	(socioeconomic or socio economic or social or economic or income or education* or occupation) N5 (inequalit* or disparit* or disadvantag* or factor* or class or difference* or status or position* or variation* or depriv* or effect* or determinant* or characteristic* or level*)
S12	S10 and S11
S13	Limit S12 to English language

Proximity operators: **Adjn** (Adjacent to – in any order), **Nn** (Near – in any order)